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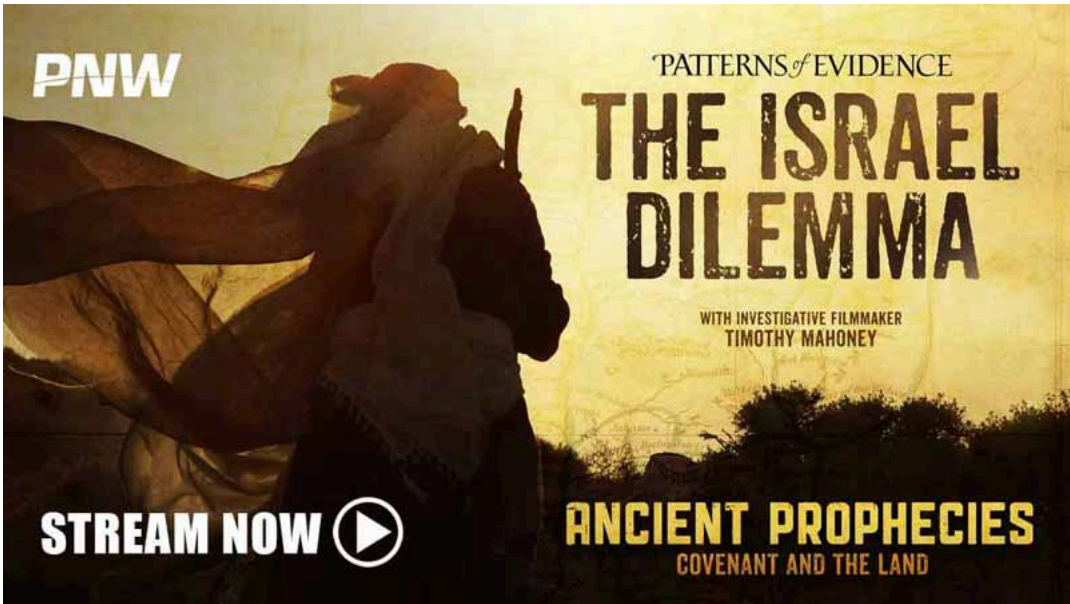
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ARTICLE

Another Child Taken By The State When Parents Refuse To Support Transition



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BY PNW STAFF MAY 22, 2026

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A growing number of parents across America are finding themselves trapped in an unimaginable nightmare: lose your child emotionally, or lose your child legally.

From California to Ohio, from Chicago to Texas, custody battles involving children who identify as transgender are increasingly ending with one consistent outcome -- the parent who refuses to affirm the transition is often pushed out of the child's life entirely.

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The latest heartbreaking case comes from California, where Orthodox Christian mother Alexandra Lyashchenko says the state seized her teenage daughter after she refused to consent to testosterone treatments and a gender transition. According to interviews she gave to NTD, California authorities have now moved toward permanently separating the child from her family and placing her up for adoption.

The allegations surrounding the case are deeply disturbing. Lyashchenko says her daughter was housed with boys in foster care because of her "gender identity," and she believes her daughter was sexually assaulted while in the system. Her family has reportedly fled California and is now hiding in Florida out of fear the state could target their younger son next.

We are rapidly entering an era where government institutions, school systems, therapists, courts, and child protective agencies increasingly operate under one ideological assumption: affirmation is mandatory.



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That shift represents one of the most dramatic transformations of parental rights in modern American history.

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In another nationally known case, Texas father Jeff Younger spent years fighting to stop the medical transition of his young son James, whom the boy's mother began presenting publicly as a girl called "Luna" at just three years old. Court rulings eventually stripped Younger of significant parental authority, and he warned that relocation to California could allow his ex-wife to bypass previous Texas restrictions regarding puberty blockers and transition procedures.

Again and again, the pattern appears similar. One parent affirms. One parent hesitates or objects. The affirming parent gains favor with courts and evaluators, while the dissenting parent is portrayed as emotionally dangerous or psychologically harmful.

In Chicago, mother Jeannette Cooper lost custody of her daughter after refusing to affirm her child's transgender identity. Public filings reportedly found no abuse. Yet Cooper was still effectively removed from her daughter's life because she would not embrace the idea that her daughter had been "born transgender."

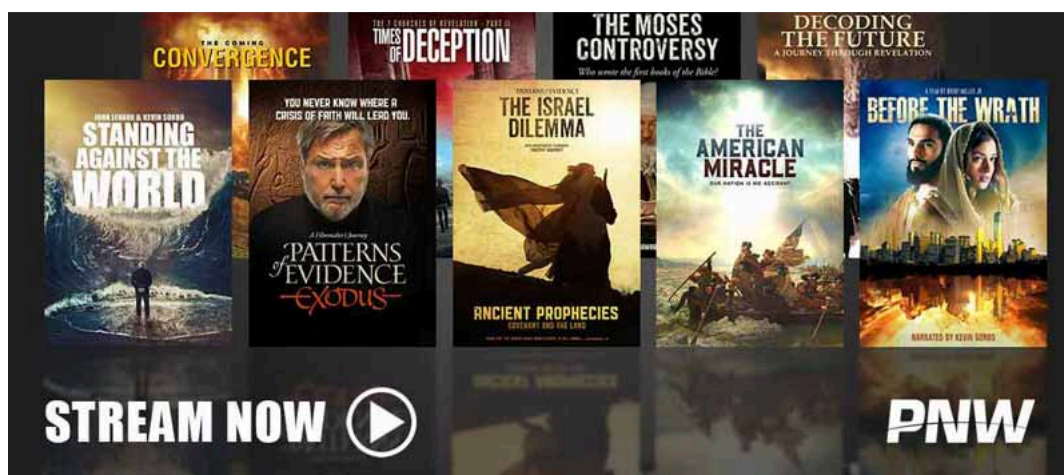
The emotional devastation is impossible to ignore.

"People who are imprisoned have more communication with their child than I do," Cooper said after missing years of birthdays, school photos, and ordinary family moments.

Perhaps most chilling is how ordinary disagreement over a deeply controversial medical issue is increasingly being reframed as neglect or abuse.

For decades, parents were expected to question major medical interventions involving children. They were expected to ask difficult questions, seek second opinions, weigh risks, and proceed cautiously. But on gender transition, many institutions now appear to demand immediate affirmation and unquestioning compliance.





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And the stakes are enormous.

The transition pathway often begins with social transition -- new names, pronouns, clothing, and identity changes -- followed by puberty blockers, cross-sex hormones, and in some cases irreversible surgeries later on. Critics argue that many of these interventions remain experimental for minors and carry serious long-term consequences, including infertility, loss of sexual function, cardiovascular risks, bone-density issues, and lifelong medical dependence.

Even some European nations that once aggressively embraced pediatric gender medicine are now retreating from it. Countries such as Sweden, Finland, and the United Kingdom have reassessed aspects of youth gender treatment after growing concerns over weak evidence, mental health outcomes, and irreversible harm.

Yet in parts of America, skepticism itself is becoming punishable.

California's SB 107 law strengthened the state's ability to assert jurisdiction in cases involving youth seeking so-called "gender-affirming care." Critics warned at the time that the law could turn California into a sanctuary state not just for transitioning minors, but for custody disputes involving parents who object.

Those warnings no longer seem hypothetical.

The deeper concern extends beyond gender ideology alone. It strikes at the heart of a foundational question: Who ultimately owns the authority to raise children -- parents or the state?

Historically, American law has overwhelmingly recognized parents as the primary guardians and decision-makers for their children unless there is clear evidence of abuse or danger. But now, in some courtrooms, refusing to affirm a child's self-declared gender identity may itself be treated as evidence of harm.

That is a radical shift with consequences that reach far beyond this single issue.



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A parent saying, "I love you too much to rush you toward irreversible medical decisions," should not be viewed as abusive. A mother believing her daughter is still her daughter should not automatically lose custody rights. A father asking for caution before puberty blockers should not be treated like a criminal.

Yet increasingly, that appears to be exactly what is happening.

And Americans should ask themselves a sobering question:

If the government can take your child because you refuse to affirm one controversial ideology today, what other deeply held beliefs could eventually place families in the crosshairs tomorrow?

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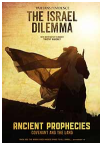
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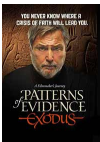
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